

■ By Nivedita Mukherjee

It was an unusual request for health-care giant Dr Reddy's Laboratories (DRL). In 2006, Catherine Dulak, while relocating to India from the US with her husband who was to join DRL, insisted on bringing her seven pet cats along. The pharmaceutical company got the feline beauties shipped pronto in customised cages made on the basis of the specifications set by airlines and government agencies.

From feline imports to gastronomic solutions to worklife balance, India Inc is ready to offer the moon to prepare the ground for a smooth blend of Indian operations with the acquired outfits. While non-Indian Infosys workers freshly recruited and posted in India get a chef specially flown in to cook food according to their taste buds, *dal* and curry are making their way into the office canteens of a Chinese company acquired by Mahindras.

Welcome to the world of mergers and acquisitions and cultural integration. As India Inc's appetite for companies on foreign shores grows, it is fast realising that the only way to address post-acquisition jitters is through sugared pills. Acquisition, after all, is not just about getting bigger with new tech-

MERGER MANTRAS

With acquisitions emerging as an integral part of corporate strategy, Indian companies put into place ideas and initiatives in the cultural and business landscape to make the mergers deliver results



POWER LUNCH: Tata with a Daewoo worker

TATA GROUP

For Ratan Tata, ethics and values are paramount and he prefers light touch integration between Indian and global operations.